Installing PHP

There are several options available to you when installing PHP, from compiling PHP's C source code to downloading an archive file containing a ready-made installation. Another (excellent) option is to run PHP via a Docker container.

Most Linux distributions have a package management system, the two most common are Apt (e.g., Debian, Ubuntu – https://debian-handbook.info/browse/stable/sect.apt-get.html) and DNF (e.g., CentOS, Fedora, Redhat – https://docs.fedoraproject.org/en-US/quick-docs/dnf/). macOS lacks a default package manager, but there is the popular Homebrew installer available here: https://brew.sh. This section will not be an exhaustive guide to using OS package management tools, but is simply designed to get you up and running as quickly as possible.

With Apt

Debian's default Apt repositories tend to offer only the latest stable release of PHP, but there is a repository maintained by Ondřej Surý, which will enable installation of most minor versions of PHP. To prepare a Debian-based system to use this repository, use the following commands:

```
$ sudo apt-get update
$ sudo apt-get -y install lsb-release ca-certificates curl
$ curl -sSLo /tmp/debsuryorg-archive-keyring.deb https://packages.sury.org/
debsuryorg-archive-keyring.deb
$ dpkg -i /tmp/debsuryorg-archive-keyring.deb
$ sh -c 'echo "deb [signed-by=/usr/share/keyrings/debsuryorg-archive-
keyring.gpg] https://packages.sury.org/php/ $(lsb_release -sc) main" > /
etc/apt/sources.list.d/php.list'
$ apt-get update
```

At the time of writing, these commands are taken from the installation script available at https://packages.sury.org/php/README.txt. With that done it should now be possible to install many different versions of PHP:

```
$ apt-cache search "php7.4 "
php7.4-cli - command-line interpreter for the PHP scripting language
php7.4-dev - Files for PHP7.4 module development
```